

Fretbox Outreach AI

User Guide

Complete reference for administrators and power users.

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Contents

1. Quick Start (5 Minutes)

2. Sign Up, Sign In, and Forgot Password

- Creating an account

- Signing in

- Resetting your password

3. Dashboard Navigation

4. Universities

- Browse the list

- Search

- Upload universities via CSV

- Sync from UGC

- Sync IITs / NITs / IIITs

- Validate Websites

- University detail view

5. Enrichment

- The enrichment chain

- How to run enrichment

- Results

6. Outreach

- Pipeline columns

- Starting a sequence

- Sequence steps

- Reverting a stage

- Skipping a university

- Client demo view

7. Approvals

Reviewing an email

Bulk approve

8. Proposals

Creating a proposal

Proposal content

Proposal statuses

Previewing and sending

Confirming, rescheduling, or cancelling a meeting

Google Calendar integration

9. Replies and Auto-Replies

Inbound reply webhook

Reply classification

Auto-replies

10. Analytics

Outreach funnel

Key metrics

Email performance

Reply intent breakdown

11. Settings

API Keys

Google Calendar test

Danger Zone

Theme

12. Email Delivery Tracking

13. Quick Tips

Need Help?

More Documentation

One-liner: Fretbox Outreach AI discovers Indian universities, enriches them with research signals, and automates personalized email sequences to book meetings for Fretbox.

1. Quick Start (5 Minutes)

1. **Sign Up or Sign In** — Open the app URL and create an account, or sign in to an existing one.
2. **Add API Keys** — Go to **Settings** → **API Keys** and add:
 - **Google Gemini API Key** — Powers AI enrichment, reply classification, and proposal generation.
 - **Serper API Key** — Discovers and validates university websites and news.
 - **Firecrawl API Key** — Deep site crawling and contact/content extraction.
 - **ZeptoMail Email API Key** — Sends all outbound emails and tracks delivery.
 - **ZeptoMail From Email** — A verified sender address for outreach.
 - **ZeptoMail Sender Name** — The name shown as the sender.
 - *(Optional)* **Google Calendar Service Account JSON + Calendar ID** — Enables meeting invites and Google Meet links from proposals.
3. **Seed Universities** — Go to **Universities** and click **Sync All UGC Universities** to import the latest government-recognized dataset.
4. **Enrich** — Go to **Enrichment**, select a batch of universities, and click **Run Deep Enrichment**.
5. **Start Outreach** — Go to **Outreach**, pick a university in **Ready to Sequence**, and click **Begin Sequence**. The first email is drafted and placed in **Approvals** for human review.
6. **Send Document Emails** — On **Outreach**, click **Document Mailer**, upload a **.docx**, choose recipients (stakeholders or custom emails), optionally attach the original and extra files, and create drafts. Review and approve them in **Approvals**.

Tip: Each API key, sender setting, and calendar credential can be saved, tested, and removed independently from the Settings page.

2. Sign Up, Sign In, and Forgot Password

Creating an account

1. Open the **Sign Up** page.
2. Enter your email and a password with at least 8 characters.
3. Click **Create account**.
4. You are signed in automatically and redirected to the dashboard.

Signing in

1. Open the **Sign In** page.
2. Enter your email and password.
3. Click **Sign in**.

Resetting your password

1. On the **Sign In** page, click **Forgot password?**
2. Enter your account email and click **Send reset code**.
3. Check your inbox for the reset code (it expires in 1 hour).
4. On the **Reset password** page, enter the code, your new password, and confirm it.
5. You are signed in automatically and redirected to the dashboard.

Tip: The reset code is sent by email via ZeptoMail. If you do not receive it, make sure **ZeptoMail Email API Key** and **ZeptoMail From Email** are configured in **Settings → API Keys**.

3. Dashboard Navigation

The left sidebar is organized into three sections:

- **CORE**
 - **Universities** — Browse, search, and manage your university list.
 - **Enrichment** — Run AI enrichment on universities.
- **PIPELINE**

- **Analytics** — View funnel metrics and email performance.
- **Outreach** — Manage sequences, monitor replies, and send document-based emails via **Document Mailer**.
- **Proposals** — Generate and send rich HTML proposals.
- **Approvals** — Review and approve pending emails before they are sent.
- **SYSTEM**
 - **Settings** — Configure API keys, sender details, and calendar integration.

Badges on the sidebar show live counts:

- **Outreach** — Number of unclassified replies.
- **Approvals** — Number of pending emails awaiting your review.

A **Sign out** button is at the bottom of the sidebar. The **Theme Toggle** is in the sidebar header next to the logo, so you can switch between light and dark mode.

4. Universities

Browse the list

The **Universities** page shows your full database in a table. Use the tabs at the top to filter by type: **All**, **Central**, **State**, **Private**, **Deemed**, and **Other**.

Each tab also shows a count badge for that type.

Search

Type at least two characters in the search bar. Results update automatically after you stop typing (with a 300 ms debounce).

Upload universities via CSV

1. Click **Upload CSV**.
2. Select a CSV with at least a `university_name` column.

Supported columns and aliases:

Column	Required	Aliases accepted	Example
university_name	Yes	Name , University	"Delhi University"
state	No	State	"Delhi"
city	No	City	"New Delhi"
website	No	Website	"https://du.ac.in"
student_count	No	Students	70000
type	No	Type	"Public", "Private", "Deemed", "Central", "State"
naac_grade	No	NAAC	"A++", "A+", "A", "B"

Edge case: Universities with a duplicate `university_name` are skipped during upload. The upload status shows how many were imported and how many were skipped.

Sync from UGC

Click **Sync All UGC Universities** to fetch the latest Indian university dataset from UGC. The action merges new and changed records into your database and shows the number of universities added and updated.

Sync IITs / NITs / IIITs

Click **Sync IITs / NITs / IIITs** to seed Institutes of National Importance (IITs, NITs, IIITs, and similar elite institutions). The action shows how many were added, updated, and skipped because they were already present.

Validate Websites

Click **Validate Websites** to schedule automated website verification across your database. Validation runs in batches of 50 and checks whether each university has a valid, discoverable, or invalid website.

University detail view

Click any table row to open a detail panel. The panel shows:

- University name, location, zip code, and a link to its website.
- Student count and UGC recognition status.

- A **Deep Enrich (AISHE + Social)** button to run the full enrichment chain on that university.
- **UGC Information** — Vice Chancellor, Registrar, and full address.
- **Student Strength (NIRF)** — Program-wise student totals, when available.
- **Student Demographics (AISHE / NAAC / SSR / NIRF)** — Total students, day scholars, hostelites, and a hostelite occupancy bar.
- **Priority Scoring** — Final health / fit score out of 100.
- **Stakeholders** — Discovered contacts with email, phone, and LinkedIn, tagged as either "UGC" or "AI Enriched".
- **AI Signals** — Recent signals from LinkedIn, Google News, Google Images, and Serper search.

Note: The current outreach stage and lead tier are visible on the Universities table and in the Outreach pipeline, not inside the detail panel.

5. Enrichment

Enrichment is the multi-phase process of using AI to research a university and extract valuable signals.

The enrichment chain

For each selected university, the system runs the following phases in order:

Phase	What it does
Discovery	Finds and validates the official website when one is missing or suspicious.
Scraping	Extracts website data, including anti-ragging and contact pages.
Social & media discovery	Searches LinkedIn, Google News, Google Images, and Serper results.
Contact inference	Infers role-based contacts from the scraped site.
Government data enrichment	Pulls AISHE, NAAC, SSR, and NIRF demographic data.
Deep enrichment	Uses all gathered signals to build a richer university profile.
Social refresh	Re-runs profile and signal discovery after new contacts are found.
Scoring	Generates a Priority Score and a lead tier (High / Medium / Low).

How to run enrichment

1. Go to **Enrichment**.
2. In the **Pending / New** column, select universities via the checkboxes.
3. Use **Select All** to quickly pick every visible university.
4. Click **Run Deep Enrichment** (the button shows how many are selected).
5. Universities move to **In Progress**, then to **Enriched** when complete.

Tip: Start with a small batch (5–10) to see how the AI personalizes signals before scaling. The system runs selected enrichments in parallel.

Results

After enrichment, a university shows:

- A **lead tier** (High / Medium / Low) in the Enrichment and Outreach cards.
- A **priority score** in the detail panel.
- **Demographics** — student totals, day scholars, and hostelites.
- **Stakeholders** — discovered contacts such as Vice Chancellor and Registrar.
- **AI Signals** — recent news, LinkedIn, and website content.

6. Outreach

The **Outreach** page is a Kanban-style pipeline that tracks where each university sits in your sales process.

Pipeline columns

The Kanban has five columns:

Column	Meaning
Ready to Sequence	Enriched and ready for first outreach.
Outreach Active	Emails are being sent as part of an active sequence.
Replied	A stakeholder has replied.
Meeting Booked	A meeting has been scheduled through a proposal.
Not Interested	The contact opted out or declined.

Each card shows the university name, location, lead tier, current outreach stage, and a meeting badge when applicable. Cards in an active sequence display the current step, total steps, status (Active or Awaiting Approval), and a progress bar.

Starting a sequence

1. Find a university in **Ready to Sequence**.
2. Click its card and then **Begin Sequence**.
3. The AI creates a 4-step sequence and drafts the first email.
4. The draft is placed in **Approvals** for human review before sending.
5. Once approved, the email is sent via ZeptoMail and the sequence resumes.

Sequence steps

The default sequence has 4 steps:

1. Initial Outreach
2. Follow-up 1
3. Value-Add Follow-up
4. Break-up / Final

Auto-replies use a special step number **99** and are visible in the approvals queue with that label.

Reverting a stage

Each Kanban card has a **Move back a step** button that rewinds the university to the previous stage.

Skipping a university

Use the **Skip University** button in the header to permanently remove a university from the active pipeline. A **Skipped List** tab lets you review and search skipped universities.

Client demo view

The **Client Demo View** button opens a read-only demo page of the pipeline.

7. Approvals

The **Approvals** page is the mandatory Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) gate. Every AI-drafted email must be reviewed before it is sent.

Reviewing an email

1. Go to **Approvals**.
2. Each card shows the step number, step label, university, recipient, subject, and body.
3. Choose an action:

Action	Result
Approve & Send	Dispatches the email immediately via ZeptoMail.
Edit	Modify the subject and body, then save. You can approve after editing.
Reject	Deletes the draft permanently and pauses the sequence for that stakeholder.

Bulk approve

If you have multiple pending drafts, click **Approve All** to send them all at once. The button shows the number of pending emails.

Tip: A quick human edit — like mentioning a recent university award or specific hostel count — can significantly improve open and reply rates.

8. Proposals

Proposals are AI-generated rich HTML deal documents tailored to each university. They are not PDFs; they are sent as HTML emails.

Creating a proposal

You can create a proposal in two ways:

- **Manually** — Click **Generate Proposal**, select a university, optionally select a stakeholder, and confirm.
- **Automatically** — When a stakeholder replies with a meeting request, the system creates a draft proposal with **Meeting Pending** status.

Proposal content

The AI produces a structured document containing:

- Executive summary (hook, why now, vision statement)
- Problem statement
- Solution overview
- Key benefits
- ROI summary
- Next steps
- Agenda

Proposal statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	The proposal is being generated.
Ready	The proposal is ready to preview and send.
Sent	The proposal has been emailed to the stakeholder.
Meeting Confirmed	A meeting has been confirmed and a Google Calendar event with a Meet link created.

Previewing and sending

1. Open a ready proposal.
2. Click **Preview & Send**.
3. The modal has two sides: the document editor on the left and send settings on the right.
4. Edit any section if needed and click **Save Draft**.
5. Select one or more recipients from the stakeholder list.

6. Optionally add CC addresses (comma-separated).
7. Click **Send Proposal**. The proposal is sent as a rich HTML email via ZeptoMail.

Confirming, rescheduling, or cancelling a meeting

When a proposal is **Meeting Pending**:

1. Click **Confirm Meeting & Create Meet Link**.
2. Choose a **start time** and a **duration** (15, 30, 45, or 60 minutes).
3. Click **Confirm & Generate Link**.
4. The system creates a Google Calendar event with a Google Meet link and updates the proposal to **Meeting Confirmed**.
5. Click **Open Meet Link** to join the call.

For confirmed meetings, the button becomes **Reschedule Meeting**. If the meeting cannot happen, click **Cancel** to set the Google Calendar event status to cancelled; the proposal remains in the system so you can reconfirm later.

Google Calendar integration

To enable automatic calendar events:

1. Go to **Settings** → **API Keys**.
2. Add your **Google Calendar Service Account JSON** (from Google Cloud).
3. Set a **Calendar ID** — use `primary` or a specific calendar. The default is `primary`.

Edge case: If a proposal has no stakeholders with email, it is generically addressed and no attendee is added automatically, but a calendar event can still be created.

9. Replies and Auto-Replies

Inbound reply webhook

When a stakeholder replies, the inbound reply webhook (`/webhooks/email-reply`) resolves the conversation context by:

- Matching the `Message-ID` / `In-Reply-To` headers to a sent email.
- Falling back to the sender email address to find the stakeholder.

If the context cannot be resolved, the webhook returns an error and the reply must be reviewed manually.

Reply classification

Once context is resolved, the system stores the raw reply and uses Gemini to classify it into one of these categories:

Classification	Follow-up action
meeting_request	Creates a draft proposal; confirms meeting in the Proposals page.
positive_interest	Continues the sequence or sends a positive follow-up.
request_info	Sends details or FAQ.
not_interested / opt_out	Stops outreach and moves the university to Not Interested .
out_of_office	Retries follow-up later.
other	Stays visible for manual review.

The outreach stage is updated automatically: `meeting_request` becomes **Meeting Booked**, `not_interested / opt_out` becomes **Not Interested**, and other replies become **Replied**.

Auto-replies

For `meeting_request`, `positive_interest`, and `request_info` replies, the system automatically sends a polite, threaded response (with proper `In-Reply-To` and `References` headers). For `meeting_request`, the response uses any existing Google Meet link when available.

High-stakes classifications (`meeting_request` or `positive_interest`) with low model confidence (below 0.85) are blocked from auto-reply and flagged for human review.

Unclassified or unmatched replies show a badge on the **Outreach** sidebar item and appear in the **Replies** panel on the Outreach page.

10. Analytics

The **Analytics** page gives a high-level view of pipeline performance.

Outreach funnel

A horizontal bar chart shows how many universities are at each stage:

Total Universities → Enriched → Outreach Active → Replied → Meeting Booked → Proposal Sent → Closed / Won

The funnel uses the exact sum of all tracked outreach stages. Each bar also shows the conversion rate from the previous stage.

Key metrics

Four cards show:

- **Reply Rate** — percentage of active outreach that received a reply.
- **Meeting Rate** — percentage of replies that booked a meeting.
- **High Tier Leads** — count of universities with a High lead tier (plus Medium tier shown as a sub-label).
- **Not Interested** — count of universities that opted out or did not reply.

Email performance

A table breaks down delivery metrics for each of the four sequence steps:

Metric	What it tells you
Sent	Emails dispatched.
Opened	Recipients opened the email.
Open Rate	Percentage of sent emails that were opened.
Clicked	Recipients clicked a link.
Bounced	Invalid email address or full mailbox.

The step labels are **Initial Outreach**, **Follow-up 1**, **Value Add**, and **Break-up**.

Reply intent breakdown

A grid of classification cards shows how stakeholders have responded and the percentage of total replies each represents.

11. Settings

The **Settings** page is where you configure all integrations and credentials.

API Keys

Each integration has its own card with a status indicator, input field, **Save**, **Test**, and **Remove** actions:

Section	What it powers
Google Gemini API Configuration	AI reasoning, reply classification, proposal generation, and enrichment.
Serper API Configuration	Google Search, News, and Image discovery during enrichment.
Firecrawl API Configuration	Deep web crawling, sitemap discovery, and contact extraction.
ZeptoMail Email API	Sending all transactional and outreach emails.
ZeptoMail From Email	Verified sender address for all outbound emails (default: <code>outreach@fretbox.in</code>).
ZeptoMail Sender Name	Display name for the sender (default: <code>Ashish Gupta (Fretbox)</code>).
Google Calendar Service Account	Creates calendar events and Google Meet links from the Proposals page.
Google Calendar ID	Target calendar for meetings (default: <code>primary</code>).

For every API key you can:

- Paste a new key and click **Save**.
- Click **Test** to verify the new key before saving.
- Click **Test Stored** to verify the currently saved key.
- Click **Remove** to delete the stored credential.

Validation: API keys are sanitized before storage. Only printable ASCII characters (33–126) are accepted; leading/trailing whitespace, control characters, and non-ASCII characters are rejected. If a key is rejected, re-enter it without extra spaces or special characters.

Google Calendar test

Click the **Test** button in the **Google Calendar Service Account** section to verify that the service account can create a test event on the configured calendar.

Danger Zone

The **Danger Zone** at the bottom of the Settings page contains **Wipe All Enrichment & Outreach Data**. Use this with caution; it permanently removes enrichment, outreach, reply, and proposal data from the workspace.

Theme

Use the **Theme Toggle** in the sidebar header to switch between light and dark mode.

12. Email Delivery Tracking

Every email sent through ZeptoMail is tracked end to end.

- When an email is approved and sent, ZeptoMail returns a `request_id`. The app stores this as `zeptomail_message_id` on the email record.
- ZeptoMail delivery webhooks (`/webhooks/zeptomail`) update the email status as the recipient interacts with it:
 - **Sent** — the API accepted the email.
 - **Delivered** — accepted by the recipient's mail server.
 - **Opened** — the recipient opened the email.
 - **Clicked** — the recipient clicked a link.
 - **Bounced** — hard or soft bounce (invalid address, full mailbox, etc.).
 - **Failed** — the send itself failed.

The app matches webhooks using the `client_reference` (the email record ID) and the `email_reference` / `request_id` returned by ZeptoMail. These statuses power the Analytics email table and the Outreach timeline.

13. Quick Tips

- **Start small** — Enrich 5–10 universities first to see how the AI personalizes emails before scaling up.
 - **Review approvals carefully** — All emails must be approved before sending. A quick human edit can significantly improve open and reply rates.
 - **Check Analytics weekly** — Use funnel, reply, and email delivery data to understand what messaging resonates.
 - **Keep API keys fresh** — If enrichment or sending suddenly stops, check Settings for expired or invalid keys.
 - **Use UGC and INI sync** — The fastest way to populate your database is with **Sync All UGC Universities** and **Sync IITs / NITs / IIITs**.
 - **Tag stakeholders** — Ensure key contacts (Vice Chancellor, Registrar) are discovered before starting outreach; sequences cannot begin without a target email.
 - **Use Skip wisely** — If a university is not a good fit, skip it rather than leaving it in the pipeline.
 - **Confirm meetings in Proposals** — A `meeting_request` reply creates a draft proposal; a human must pick the date and time before a Google Meet link is created.
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Need Help?

If a feature is not working as expected:

1. **Check Settings** — Ensure all required API keys are valid and have active quotas.
2. **Check Analytics** — Look for bounced emails or failed enrichments.
3. **Check Approvals** — Make sure pending drafts are not stuck awaiting review.
4. **Check Outreach** — Review unclassified replies that may need manual attention.
5. **Check the University detail view** — Verify the university has a discovered website and at least one stakeholder with an email before running outreach.
6. **Check reply/thread matching** — If a reply is not auto-processed, confirm it was sent in reply to a tracked email and that the sender address matches a known stakeholder.

Still stuck? Capture any error messages from the browser console and share them with your team.

More Documentation

- [Project README](#)
- [Codebase map](#)
- [Quick user guide](#)
- [Implementation plan](#)
- [Requirements](#)
- [Roadmap](#)
- [Design system](#)